

Westbound Empire Productions The Engine

A Project Brief for Utkarsh Gupta (UG)

The build map for the first AI-native music-and-movie universe.

A movie with live music drops. The mystery is when the next song hits.

Version 2.0
May 15, 2026

What We're Building

The frame, the artist, the audience.

UG — Westbound is building something that doesn't exist yet: a serialized movie distributed across every entertainment channel, with original songs dropping inside the story as part of the marketing. Weekly episodes — shorts and long-form, varied — and unpredictable song drops between them. The mystery of when the next song hits is the hook.

Sammy Rane

Sammy Rane is the artist at the center. Mid-30s, flawed, undiscovered, on the verge. From Indiana, moved to LA. The drama is his previous life pulling at his current one — relationships, ambition, the cost of the climb. His sound is heartland alt-rock with Americana bones — Cornell, Stephen Wilson Jr., Vedder, Grohl in the vocal lane. His story drives the music.

The Audience

The lane is hot. Gen Z is rediscovering alt-rock and post-grunge — Soundgarden, Nirvana, Foo Fighters, Pearl Jam catalog streams are surging. The new generation owning the lane (Stephen Wilson Jr., Zach Bryan, Noah Kahan, Tyler Childers) is selling out arenas. The audience runs from Gen Z all the way up to people in their 60s who never left. That whole range is the market.

A movie with live music drops. The mystery is when the next song hits.

The Stack

High level. UG knows the tools — one line of context each.

MUSIC › Suno v5.5 Premier — song generation › Logic Pro — mix, polish, master › iZotope RX / Ozone — pro mastering for hero tracks › Producer rotation — 10 producers, one per song, named in the Suno style box	VISUAL › Midjourney v7+ — character + scene generation › LoRA training — custom Sammy LoRA, locked across every render › IP-Adapter / ControlNet — face lock, pose control › ComfyUI — node pipeline for repeatable Sammy generations › SDXL / Flux — local generation when we need more control
VIDEO › Veo 3, Runway Gen-4, Sora 2, Pika 2.0, Kling — generation › Higgsfield — cinematic camera control › DaVinci Resolve — edit, color, master › HeyGen / Wav2Lip — talking Sammy, lip sync	VOICE › ElevenLabs — Sammy's speaking voice trained to match his singing voice › Lip sync pipeline — on-camera dialogue
DISTRIBUTION › YouTube (long + Shorts), TikTok, Instagram, Facebook, X, Spotify, Substack, Discord › DistroKid / TuneCore — music distribution › Chartmetric — industry analytics	WRITING ROOM › Notion / Obsidian — universe bible, character bibles, episode breakdowns, song tracker, content calendar

What You're Building

Here's the work, high level. You'll fill in the gaps and tell me where the architecture needs to be different.

01 The Sammy Consistency Pipeline

Lock Sammy's face, body, wardrobe, and locations across thousands of generated assets. LoRA training, ComfyUI workflows, asset versioning. This is the crown jewel.

02 The Voice Layer

Train Sammy's speaking voice to match his singing voice. ElevenLabs primary. Build the lip-sync pipeline so on-camera Sammy reads as one person.

03 The Video Engine

Orchestrate Veo / Runway / Sora / Pika / Kling for the weekly movie drops. Shorts and long-form. Color and edit in Resolve.

04 The Asset Library

Storage, tagging, versioning, retrieval across every Sammy generation, every location, every B-roll texture, every song master.

05 The Publishing Pipeline

Cross-platform publishing automation — when a song drops, when an episode drops, every platform fires native-format content within 24 hours.

06 The Production Dashboard

A real-time view of where every song, episode, and asset is in the pipeline. We never lose track of state.

You'll see what I'm missing faster than I will. That's why you're running this.

Some of this is in your hands today. Some of it (LoRA training at scale, ComfyUI node design, cross-platform publishing orchestration) may need you to learn fast or bring in a hand. Your call. Your classmate at Suno may be useful — pull that thread if it helps.

First Moves

Priority order, not dates. We hit them in sequence.

1. Lock Sammy's visual reference set (hero portrait, wardrobe, locations)
2. Train the Sammy LoRA
3. Stand up the asset library
4. Train Sammy's speaking voice
5. Build the first three song-and-episode pairs (song + mini-movie + shorts)
6. Stand up the publishing pipeline (YouTube first)
7. Soft launch with episode 1 + first song drop
8. Iterate from real data
9. Hit weekly cadence
10. Scale

That's the build. Tell me what you'd change. Tell me what you'd add. Tell me what you'd cut. The doc gets sharper because you read it.

We're building the first AI-native music-and-movie universe that earns its audience instead of fooling them. Sammy Rane is the proof.

Let's go.

— *Dan*

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